VALISTERA KNOWLEDGE LIBRARY

GMP Documentation Review Checklist

A practical review tool for controlled GMP documents, records and data-integrity readiness

Use this checklist to review whether GMP documentation is clear, controlled, complete, attributable, contemporaneous, traceable and suitable to support reliable quality decisions.

Resource code	VSR-GMP-CHK-002
Version	9.0
Issue date	October 2026
Primary basis	EU GMP Part I Chapter 4; FDA 21 CFR Parts 210/211; FDA Data Integrity guidance; PIC/S PI 041-1
Applicability	Paper, electronic and hybrid GMP documents and records used across pharmaceutical quality, manufacturing and laboratory operations.

Client-first. Evidence-led. Lifecycle-minded.

Pune, Maharashtra, India | Remote services available worldwide

IMPORTANT USE NOTE

This checklist is an educational and professional working aid. It is not regulatory advice, a site-approved controlled template, or a substitute for the manufacturer's Pharmaceutical Quality System (PQS). Adapt, verify and approve it through your own QMS before use.
© 2026 ValiStera Solutions. Redistribution, resale, rebranding or removal of ValiStera identification without written permission is prohibited.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

Review documentation as part of a *controlled quality process.*

Use YES / NO / N/A for each checkpoint and capture objective evidence, the identified gap or the required action. Items marked as a Critical Gate should normally be resolved before the record is relied upon for a GMP decision, release decision or inspection evidence.

STEP	FOCUS	HOW TO APPLY
1	**Define the record set**	Identify the document/record type, process, batch, system or activity being reviewed and confirm the applicable procedure and retention rule.
2	**Verify the controlled state**	Confirm the correct approved version, effective status, issuance/control status and document ownership before reviewing content.
3	**Review for GDP and integrity**	Assess entries for completeness, traceability, contemporaneous recording, correction practices, signatures/initials and supporting data.
4	**Follow the evidence**	Confirm calculations, attachments, raw data, audit-trail or metadata links, deviations and supporting records can be retrieved and reconciled.
5	**Record and close actions**	Document gaps with clear ownership, target dates and risk-based priorities; verify completion before final disposition where required.

Suggested review outcome

READY - documentation is controlled, complete and suitable for its intended GMP use.

READY WITH ACTIONS - no critical gap prevents use, but defined actions remain.

NOT READY - critical control, data-integrity or completeness gaps require resolution before reliance.

ValiStera

SECTION A - DOCUMENT GOVERNANCE

Controlled-document status and approval

Start by confirming that the document is the correct, approved and controlled record for its intended GMP use.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
A1	Document title and unique identifier match the intended process, activity, product, system or record type.	YES				
A2	Revision/version number and effective date are present and match the current approved master.	YES				
A3	Document status is clear (e.g., effective, superseded, draft, obsolete) and obsolete copies are prevented from unintended use.	YES				
A4	The document owner / responsible function is defined.					
A5	Required approvers are identified and approvals are complete before effective use.	YES				
A6	Change history or revision rationale is available where required by procedure.					
A7	Controlled-copy issuance, distribution or access is managed in accordance with the site procedure.					
A8	Referenced procedures, forms, specifications and attachments are current and available.					

ValiStera

© 2026 ValiStera Solutions | www.valistera.com | contact@valistera.com

SECTION B - CONTENT QUALITY

Clear instructions, criteria and responsibilities

GMP documentation should be understandable, unambiguous and sufficiently detailed for consistent execution and review.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
B1	Purpose and scope are clear and consistent with the intended GMP activity.					
B2	Responsibilities and required roles are defined where relevant.					
B3	Instructions are written in a clear sequence and avoid ambiguous or conflicting wording.	**YES**				
B4	Acceptance criteria, limits or decision rules are predefined where the activity requires them.	**YES**				
B5	Required equipment, instruments, materials, forms and supporting records are identified where applicable.					
B6	Units, calculations, rounding rules and formulae are clear and technically appropriate.					
B7	Abbreviations, terminology and references are consistent with approved site standards.					
B8	Document format provides adequate space and fields to capture the required GMP evidence.					

ValiStera

SECTION C - GOOD DOCUMENTATION PRACTICE

Attributable, legible and contemporaneous entries

Review completed entries for traceability, permanence and evidence that the activity was recorded as it occurred.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
C1	Entries are legible, durable and recorded using an approved medium or system that preserves the record.	YES				
C2	Entries are made at the time the activity is performed or as required by the approved process.	YES				
C3	Each entry can be attributed to the person who performed or verified the activity.	YES				
C4	Dates and times are recorded in the approved format and are internally consistent with the sequence of events.					
C5	Blank or unused fields are handled in accordance with procedure (e.g., N/A or cancellation of unused space where appropriate).					
C6	Corrections preserve the original entry and remain traceable to the person making the correction; reason/date are recorded where required.	YES				
C7	Original information is not obscured, overwritten, backdated or otherwise rendered unreadable.	YES				
C8	Late entries, reconstructed entries or transcriptions are identified and justified in accordance with procedure.	YES				

ValiStera

SECTION D - COMPLETENESS AND TRACEABILITY

A complete record with retrievable supporting evidence

The record should tell the full GMP story: what was done, by whom, when, against what criteria and with what result.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
D1	All required pages, fields, attachments and supporting records are present or traceably referenced.	YES				
D2	Page numbering / pagination and document identification prevent loss or substitution of pages where applicable.					
D3	Raw data, source data, printouts or electronic-record references are identifiable and retrievable.	YES				
D4	Calculations and transcriptions are independently checked where required by procedure or risk.					
D5	Deviations, discrepancies, atypical events, OOS/OOT results or exceptions are cross-referenced to the applicable investigation record.	YES				
D6	Supporting evidence can be reconciled with the recorded conclusion or disposition.	YES				
D7	Attachments are identified, attributable to the parent record and protected from mix-up or loss.					
D8	The final record is complete enough to reconstruct the activity and support a later review or inspection.	YES				

ValiStera

SECTION E - MANUFACTURING AND BATCH RECORDS

Execution evidence for production and packaging

Apply these checkpoints when reviewing executed manufacturing, processing, packaging or related batch documentation.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
E1	Product, strength, dosage form, batch/lot number and relevant manufacturing stage are correctly identified.	YES				
E2	Material/component identities, lot numbers and actual quantities are recorded and traceable.	YES				
E3	Equipment / line / room identifiers and required line-clearance or status checks are documented.					
E4	Critical processing times, temperatures, pressures, speeds or other parameters are recorded where required.	YES				
E5	In-process controls, sampling, yields and reconciliations are documented and meet predefined criteria or are investigated.	YES				
E6	Actual results can be distinguished clearly from target, set-point or expected values.					
E7	Deviations and interventions are documented, assessed and linked to the relevant quality-system record.	YES				
E8	Required production and quality-review signatures / approvals are complete before final disposition.	YES				

ValiStera

SECTION F - LABORATORY AND QUALITY-CONTROL RECORDS

Complete analytical and test evidence

Laboratory records should preserve complete test evidence, including supporting data needed to understand and reconstruct the analysis.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
F1	Sample identification, batch/lot number, test request and specification/method version are traceable.	YES				
F2	Instrument / equipment identification and relevant status (e.g., qualification/calibration) are traceable where required.					
F3	Reference standards, reagents, columns, media or critical consumables are identified where required by the method.					
F4	Calculations, dilutions, integration or processing steps are documented sufficiently to reconstruct the result.	YES				
F5	All reportable results and required supporting data are retained; invalidated or repeated testing is scientifically justified and investigated as required.	YES				
F6	OOS, OOT, atypical or suspect results are linked to the applicable investigation and are not excluded without justified disposition.	YES				
F7	Chromatograms, spectra, worksheets, images or electronic data can be linked reliably to the reported result.	YES				
F8	Review evidence demonstrates that the analyst result and relevant source data were checked in accordance with procedure.	YES				

ValiStera

SECTION G - ELECTRONIC AND HYBRID DOCUMENTATION

Data integrity across electronic records and paper/electronic combinations

Apply these checkpoints where records are created, processed, approved or retained electronically, including hybrid workflows.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
G1	User access is role-appropriate and each user is uniquely attributable; shared credentials are not used for GMP actions.	YES				
G2	Electronic records retain the data and metadata necessary to reconstruct the GMP activity.	YES				
G3	Audit trails are enabled and reviewed where required by the system, procedure, risk and applicable regulation.	YES				
G4	Electronic signatures / approvals meet applicable procedural and regulatory requirements and remain linked to the signed record.	YES				
G5	Data transfer, transcription, migration or interface steps are controlled and verified where they could affect GMP data.	YES				
G6	Printouts used as GMP records are complete, verified and linked to the authoritative electronic record where applicable.					
G7	Hybrid records provide an unambiguous link between paper and electronic components so the complete record can be reconstructed.	YES				
G8	Backup, recovery and archival arrangements protect availability and integrity throughout the required retention period.	YES				

ValiStera

SECTION H - REVIEW, RETENTION AND LIFECYCLE CONTROL

Quality review, archival and continued retrievability

The record lifecycle is not complete until review, approval, retention, retrieval and authorised disposition are controlled.

REF	CHECKPOINT	CRITICAL	YES	NO	N/A	EVIDENCE / GAP / ACTION
H1	Required technical / supervisory / quality review has been completed by appropriately authorised personnel.	YES				
H2	Review includes assessment of errors, omissions, deviations and supporting evidence rather than signature-only confirmation.	YES				
H3	Changes after approval or completion are controlled and traceable in accordance with the approved procedure.	YES				
H4	The applicable retention period is defined and consistent with regulatory and site requirements.	YES				
H5	Storage conditions protect records from loss, damage, unauthorised alteration and deterioration.	YES				
H6	Records can be retrieved within a reasonable time and remain legible and complete throughout retention.	YES				
H7	Archived electronic records remain accessible with the required software/system context, metadata and security controls.					
H8	Destruction / disposal after the retention period is authorised, documented and performed in accordance with procedure.					

ValiStera

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Document-review conclusion and action tracker

Summarise the overall documentation state and identify any action that must be completed before the record is relied upon for a GMP decision.

Document / record reviewed	
Document ID / batch / system reference	
Applicable procedure / standard	
Review date	
Reviewer	
Overall outcome	READY / READY WITH ACTIONS / NOT READY
Critical gaps open?	YES / NO

NO.	GAP / ACTION	RISK / PRIORITY	OWNER	TARGET DATE	CLOSED
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					

Critical review principle

A completed checklist does not by itself demonstrate GMP compliance. The reviewer should evaluate the significance of each gap in context, ensure data-integrity concerns are investigated appropriately, and apply the site PQS and approved procedures when deciding whether the record is acceptable for use.

ValiStera

REGULATORY REFERENCE BASIS

Reference points used to structure this working aid

This resource is intentionally principle-based. Always confirm the current version of applicable regulations, guidance and site procedures before use.

1. **European Commission - EudraLex Volume 4, Part I, Chapter 4: Documentation.** Current published Chapter 4 establishes core expectations for GMP documentation, generation/control, record completion, retention and legibility.
2. **21 CFR Parts 210 and 211.** Particularly relevant finished-product record expectations include 21 CFR 211.180 (records and reports), 211.186 (master production and control records), 211.188 (batch production and control records) and 211.194 (laboratory records).
3. **FDA - Data Integrity and Compliance With Drug CGMP: Questions and Answers (2018).** Clarifies FDA expectations for reliable and accurate CGMP data and risk-based controls for data integrity.
4. **PIC/S PI 041-1 - Good Practices for Data Management and Integrity in Regulated GMP/GDP Environments (1 July 2021).** Provides detailed data-management and integrity principles applicable to paper, electronic and hybrid records.
5. **21 CFR Part 11 and EU GMP Annex 11, where applicable.** Consider electronic-record, electronic-signature and computerised-system requirements when GMP records are managed electronically.

STATUS NOTE - OCTOBER 2026

The European Commission has consulted on revisions to Chapter 4 and Annex 11. This checklist uses the currently published GMP framework and established data-integrity principles; draft consultation text should not be treated as an effective requirement unless and until formally adopted.

Professional-use disclaimer

ValiStera Solutions provides this checklist as a free educational and professional working aid. It is not legal or regulatory advice and does not replace approved site procedures, validation/document-control systems, quality-unit decisions, or competent regulatory interpretation. Users remain responsible for adapting and approving the resource within their own quality-management system.